the West Bank and its claim to all of Jerusalem, I sent a personal letter to him meant to supplement a more detailed briefing on the plan to be given to him by our excellent ambassador in Israel, Samuel Lewis. My letter read in part:

> Dear Menachem:
>
> Much has happened since we last met in Washington in June. We both have been witness to historic events culminating in the departure of the P.L.O. from Beirut and from its dominant position in Lebanese affairs. . . .
>
> The population in the north of Israel is now secure and I hope it will remain so. I feel there are now opportunities which lie before us with the P.L.O. military weakened and the Soviet Union shown once again to have minimal impact on the truly significant developments in the Middle East.
>
> I have done much soul searching in an effort to determine how to best take advantage of this situation in a way that will promote the interests of both the United States and Israel. I feel now is the appropriate time for the two of us to mount a major new effort in the Camp David peace process . . . history will not forgive us if we fail to do so. . . . We have a unique opportunity to take a major step toward a comprehensive peace which provides for the security of Israel while recognizing the legitimate rights of the Palestinian people. . . .
>
> I have asked Ambassador Lewis to share with you my thoughts on the key issues that must be resolved if we are to achieve genuine peace as Israel and the U.S. so devoutly wish.
>
> I am well aware your view varies considerably from some of my positions. I am convinced, nevertheless, that taken together the positions we are advocating can lead to a just and comprehensive and durable settlement promised by the Camp David framework. . .